sons and daughters were spread around the globe as businessmen, labourers and students. The British Indian army served in far-off places, justifying the Congress's interest in the treatment of Indians everywhere as well as in events that affected Indian lives.

Many of the positions adopted during the independence struggle have resonated in India's post-Independence world view. For example, Dadabhai Naoroji's epic work *Poverty and UnBritish Rule in India* (1901) and the writings of Romesh Chunder Dutt (1848–1909) on the British agricultural and revenue arrangements in India inspired the socialist economic policies of the Indian National Congress and post-Independence India. Naoroji's 1901 book was written as a critique of Britain's economic exploitation of India and was meant to advance the case for Indian independence.

The Congress was, in principle, against involvement of Indian troops in any imperialist war or adventure. Still, during World War I the Congress supported the Allied war effort with medical units and military volunteers. Mahatma Gandhi was amongst those who supported and pushed for this assistance. Gandhi and others hoped that if India supported the British, the latter would grant India Dominion status after the end of the war. They were, however, disappointed.

In 1919, the Congress planned to send a delegation led by veteran Congress leader, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, to the Peace Conference at Versailles, but the British government refused to provide passports to members of the delegation. Tilak then sent a letter to Georges Benjamin Clemenceau, French prime minister and president of the Peace Conference. In his letter Tilak wrote: 'India is self-contained, harbours no designs upon the integrity of other states and has no ambition outside. With her vast area, enormous resources and prodigious population she may well aspire to be a leading power in Asia. She could therefore be a powerful steward of the League of Nations for maintaining peace of the world'.[71] The wording of